UNIT PLAN – Music

CLASS: Form 4, Term 3

UNIT: From Listener to Arranger: Creating and Performing a Calypso Arrangement

GOALS: This unit should help student to:

- Develop the ability to identify and analyse the musical characteristics of calypso through active listening.
- Apply knowledge of rhythm, melody, harmony, texture, timbre, structure, and expressive elements in practical music-making.
- Develop the ability to transform existing musical material into a coherent calypso arrangement.
- Develop ensemble performance, rehearsal, communication, and collaborative decision-making skills.
- Develop creative, critical-thinking, problem-solving and reflective skills through arranging.
- Use notation, graphic representation and digital music technology where appropriate to document and develop musical ideas.
- Build appreciation of calypso as a significant Caribbean musical expression and encourage students to engage with it as creators as well as listeners.

Skills, Knowledge, Attitudes and Values

Skills:

- Critical listening and musical analysis
- Rhythmic performance and creation
- Melodic and harmonic manipulation
- Arrangement planning
- Instrumental/vocal part creation
- Ensemble rehearsal and performance
- Peer feedback and revision
- Notation/graphic representation
- Digital music creation and recording

Knowledge:

- Calypso as a Caribbean popular style
- Musical characteristics associated with calypso
- Rhythm, syncopation, metre and accompaniment patterns
- Melody, harmony and bass accompaniment
- Timbre, instrumentation and texture
- Phrase and sectional structure
- Repetition, contrast, variation, call-and-response and ostinato
- Expressive elements: tempo, dynamics and articulation
- Basic principles of arranging for available performers

Attitudes and Values:

- Creativity
- Collaboration
- Confidence
- Cultural appreciation
- Respect for others' musical ideas
- Perseverance
- Responsibility
- Openness to feedback
- Independence

RATIONALE:

This unit is designed around the principle that students learn music most meaningfully when they move between listening, doing, creating, performing, and reflecting. Rather than approaching Calypso as a purely historical unit, students will investigate how musical choices create stylistic identity and apply their discoveries to create an arrangement. This unit asks students to move from passive listeners, identifying musical features in isolation, to active arrangers who apply these features in authentic music-making. Some learners may be stronger performers than theorists, while others may understand theory but need more opportunities to apply it aurally and practically. The unit therefore connects listening, theory and performance through repeated opportunities to hear, imitate, manipulate, create, rehearse and explain.

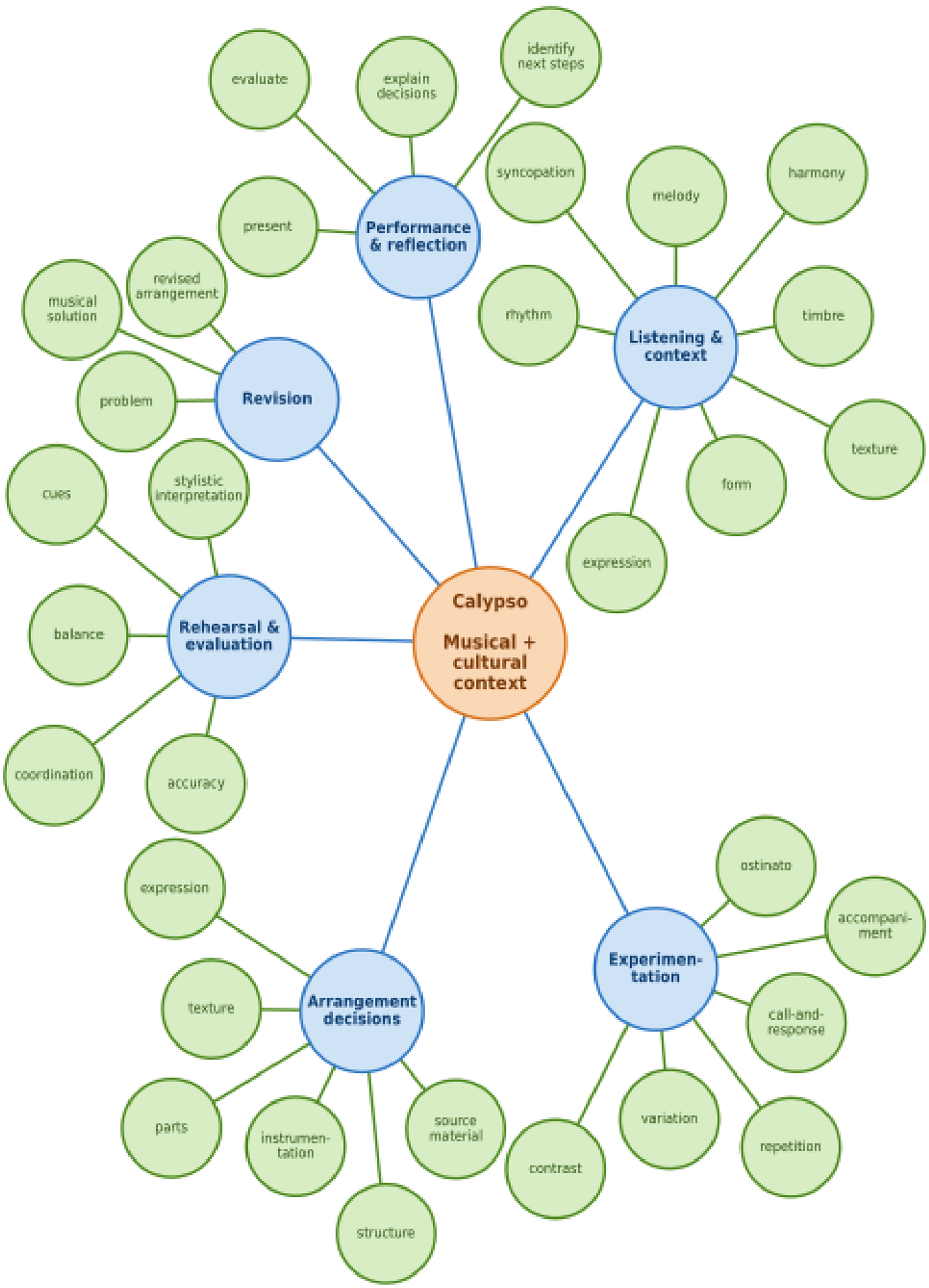
The unit begins with guided listening and practical imitation to give students the skills and tools necessary to progress into musical experimentation, analysis of existing arrangements, planning, rehearsal, performance, and reflection. This sequence provides a scaffolded approach to move students from recognition to independent musical decision-making. It also supports students who may be more confident performing without reading notation, while still creating opportunities to document musical ideas through notation, chord symbols, graphic representations, or digital tools.

The CSEC Music syllabus emphasises creativity, critical thinking, listening, problem-solving, technology, independent learning, and collaboration. It encourages teachers to use guided questions, observation, performance, and repetition to support student learning. In composing and arranging, students are expected to manipulate musical elements, use compositional devices, consider the abilities of performers, document their creative process, and reflect on challenges and solutions. This unit puts these expectations into practice through a practical, student-centred approach to creating and performing a calypso arrangement.

The unit aligns with the CSEC Music syllabus by:

- LIAP (Listening and Appraising) – identifying and discussing musical characteristics, style, and context.
- LIAP: Music Literacy and Perception – applying rhythm, melody, harmony, notation, and aural skills.
- COMP (Composing and Arranging) – mapping structure, manipulating rhythmic/melodic/harmonic concepts, using compositional devices, arranging vocal/instrumental music, scoring/recording, and reflection.
- PERF (Performing) – maintaining an independent part, responding to cues, listening for balance, rehearsal, and expressive performance.

Concepts to be taught: (Concept map /Graphic organiser)



Unit Content

The table below contains the following information:

- Lesson number in unit plan
- Lesson content
- Key Concepts to be taught in the lesson
- Learning outcomes
- Values and attitudes
- Resources needed for each lesson
- Teaching and learning activities
- Assessment strategies

CONTENT	Key concepts in the lesson	Learning outcomes: Students will be able to	Values and attitudes	RESOURCES	TEACHING/LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ASSESSMENT strategies
Lesson 1: Introduction to Calypso: cultural context, characteristics of calypso, rhythm, melody, instrumentation, texture, structure, and expression in selected examples.	Musical style is created through the interaction of musical elements and cultural context.	• Identify characteristics of calypso through listening • Describe how musical elements contribute to the calypso sound • Distinguish calypso from other Caribbean musical styles • Use appropriate terminology when discussing examples	• Appreciation of Caribbean culture • Curiosity • Active listening • Respect for different musical perspectives	• Calypso recordings • Speakers • Listening guide • Whiteboard • Projector • Comparison chart	• Teacher-guided listening • Calypso Musical Detective activity • Aural identification of elements • Small-group discussion • Compare two contrasting examples • Class shares findings	• Teacher questioning • Listening worksheet • Observation of student responses • Exit ticket (key calypso characteristics)
Lesson 2: Rhythmic Identity of Calypso: pulse, metre, syncopation,	Rhythm contributes strongly to the identity and	• Maintain a steady pulse • Perform basic calypso rhythmic patterns	• Cooperation • Confidence • Discipline	• Rhythm cards • Percussion/Body percussion	• Rhythm imitation • Body-percussion warm-up	• Teacher observation checklist

accents, rhythmic patterns, ostinato, and accompaniment patterns.	movement of a musical style.	• Identify syncopation and accents in examples • Create and perform a short rhythmic ostinato • Explain how rhythmic choices contribute to calypso style	• Willingness to experiment • Appreciation of rhythmic traditions	• Audio examples • Notation/graphic rhythm examples • Whiteboard	• Rhythm card challenges • Small-group rhythm laboratory • Layer ostinatos • Perform patterns over a calypso recording	• Rhythmic performance • Peer feedback • Questioning • Short written identification task
Lesson 3: Melody, Harmony, and Accompaniment: melodic phrases, repetition and variation, chords, bass patterns, accompaniment patterns, and call and response.	A successful arrangement combines complementary melodic and harmonic roles.	• Identify melody, bass and accompaniment roles • Recognise repetition and variation in melodic material • Perform or construct simple accompaniment patterns • Experiment with harmonic support for a melody • Explain how accompaniment can change the character of a melody	• Creativity • Collaboration • Persistence • Openness to musical experimentation	• Keyboards • Chord charts • Recordings • Melody excerpts • MuseScore • Laptops	• Aural comparison of arrangements • Melody/accompaniment sorting • Chord/accompaniment challenge • Students experiment with different accompaniment patterns • Call and response activity	• Performance observation • Group task • Questioning • Aural identification • Teacher feedback on musical experimentation
Lesson 4: Timbre, Texture, and Instrumentation: instrumental/vocal	Instrumentation and texture determine how musical ideas	• Identify different timbres in calypso arrangements	• Respect for individual abilities • Cooperation	• Steelpans • Recordings	• Texture challenge • Listening and instrument-role identification	• Observation checklist

timbres, roles of instruments, monophonic, homophonic, and layered textures, ensemble balance, range and performance capabilities.	are presented and experienced.	• Describe changes in texture • Assign appropriate musical roles to available performers/instruments • Explain how instrumentation affects an arrangement • Create a short layered texture	• Inclusion • Sensitivity to ensemble needs • Appreciation of different timbres	• Instrument cards • Texture diagrams • Arrangement chart	• Students build layers using voice/body percussion/ steelpans • Groups experiment with changing texture • Discuss balance and performer capabilities	• Group performance • Questioning • Texture identification activity • Peer response
Lesson 5: Analysing Existing Arrangements: form and structure, introductions, instrumental sections, transitions, repetition, variation, contrast, call and response, and other arrangement devices.	Arrangement involves purposeful decisions that give a piece structure, contrast, and unity.	• Identify sections within an arrangement • Trace the structure of a selected calypso arrangement • Identify arrangement devices • Explain how musical elements change between sections • Apply observations from existing arrangements to their own work	• Critical thinking • Attentive listening • Appreciation • Analytical thinking • Willingness to justify ideas	• Selected calypso arrangements • Arrangement-analysis worksheet • Structural maps • Recordings • Projector • Speakers	• Arrangement detectives • Students listen and map sections • Students identify changes in instrumentation, rhythm, texture, and dynamics • Compare arrangements • Groups explain why particular choices may have been made	• Completed arrangement analysis • Group presentation • Questioning • Structural mapping • Peer discussion

Lesson 6: Designing a Calypso Arrangement: selecting source material, arrangement blueprint, structure, instrumentation, roles, rhythm, harmony, texture, expressive elements.	An arrangement is created by making intentional decisions about how existing musical material will be transformed.	• Select suitable source material • Develop an arrangement blueprint • Make purposeful decisions about structure and instrumentation • Assign appropriate parts to performers • Incorporate at least two manipulated musical elements • Justify key arrangement decisions	• Creativity • Responsibility • Collaboration • Problem-solving • Respect for group decisions	• Arrangement blueprint template • Steelpans • Chord and Rhythm banks • Recordings • MuseScore • Laptops	• Teacher models planning process • Groups select source material • Complete arrangement blueprint • Determine structure and instrumentation • Experiment with sections • Teacher conferences with groups • Revise plans	• Arrangement blueprint • Teacher conference notes • Planning checklist • Questioning • Peer review • Formative feedback
Lesson 7: Rehearsing, Evaluating, and Revising: ensemble coordination, accuracy, tempo, balance, dynamics, cues, stylistic interpretation, problem-solving, revision.	Effective arrangements develop through rehearsal, feedback, and purposeful revision.	• Rehearse an arrangement effectively • Maintain an independent part within an ensemble • Respond to cues and changes • Evaluate accuracy, balance and stylistic interpretation • Identify performance problems	• Perseverance • Accountability • Teamwork • Self-discipline • Willingness to improve	• Steelpans • Arrangement scores/charts • Rehearsal checklist • Recording device • Peer feedback form • Metronome	• Group rehearsal • Teacher modelling of rehearsal techniques • Groups record rehearsal excerpts • Peer assessment • Identify problems • Revise parts • Structure or interpretation • Repeat and evaluate	• Rehearsal observation • Peer assessment form • Recording evidence • Self-assessment • Teacher feedback • Revision checklist

		• Make appropriate revisions based on feedback				
Lesson 8: Performance and Reflection: presentation of completed calypso arrangement, performance interpretation, evaluation, reflection on creative decisions and learning.	Musical knowledge becomes meaningful when students apply, communicate, and evaluate it through performance.	• Perform/present a coherent calypso arrangement • Demonstrate appropriate stylistic characteristics • Perform accurately and collaboratively • Respond to musical cues and maintain ensemble balance • Evaluate the completed arrangement • Explain significant creative decisions and identify areas for further development	• Confidence • Pride in achievement • Respect for performers • Responsibility • Reflection • Appreciation of Caribbean musical expression	• Final arrangements • Steelpans • Recording device • Rubric • Reflection sheet	• Final group performances • Audience listening/evaluation • Teacher assessment • Student reflection • Brief group explanation of arrangement decisions • Post-performance discussion	• Summative performance rubric • Self-assessment • Peer feedback • Written reflection • Teacher observation • group viva voce